

KARTHIK S

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Portfolio : <https://karthiksasath-gif.github.io/cybersecurity-portfolio/>

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Entry-level SOC analyst with an M.Sc in Cyber Forensics & Cyber Security (2026) and hands-on experience in alert triage, log analysis and detection engineering, gained through a security operations internship and documented lab investigations. Works in Splunk, Elastic Security and Wazuh, using Sysmon, Wireshark and Snort for endpoint and network evidence. Writes clear investigation notes with True/False Positive reasoning and tunes detection rules (KQL, EQL) to cut alert noise. Seeking an entry-level SOC Analyst or Incident Response role to monitor and triage alerts, support investigations and help improve detection quality.

EXPERIENCE

- **Intern | Sworks Infotech Pvt Ltd | May 2025 – July 2025**
 - Supported security operations by monitoring, analyzing and documenting security events using SIEM and IDS/IPS tools.
 - Assisted with vulnerability assessments and security reviews across systems and applications.
 - Performed network traffic analysis and log inspection with Wireshark, Wazuh and Snort to identify suspicious activity. - Documented findings, risks and mitigation recommendations for incident response workflows, following established escalation procedures.

PROJECTS (hands-on lab projects, each with a full write-up on GitHub)

- **Security Detection Engineering & Attack Chain Analysis | Elastic Security**
 - Wrote atomic, threshold, and EQL correlation detections for a simulated attack chain (reconnaissance, RDP brute force, credential access, lateral movement), using KQL, EQL and MITRE ATT&CK; demonstrated anomaly-based detection through baselining in Discover.
 - Built a threshold rule that flagged a password spray (50 failed logons, 10 usernames, one IP) and a correlation rule that detects a successful RDP logon after repeated failures, with alert suppression to remove duplicate alerts.
 - Reworked a noisy reconnaissance rule using session-based grouping (host + LogonId), reducing alerts from 22 to 1.
- **Windows Endpoint Compromise & Kill Chain Investigation | Windows/Sysmon**
 - Reconstructed the kill chain of a simulated Windows compromise from Security logs, Sysmon and PowerShell history: rogue admin-group account, malware download and execution, startup-folder persistence and a C2 connection.
 - Extracted IOCs (file paths, C2 IP and domain, accounts) and wrote prioritized response actions: isolate host, block C2, rotate credentials.
- **SIEM-Based Log Analysis & Threat Investigation | Splunk**
 - Investigated Windows Sysmon, Linux authentication and web server logs in Splunk and linked them into one multi-stage intrusion.
 - Identified malware with scheduled-task persistence, a compromised Linux account with privilege escalation, an unauthorized SSH account with a cron reverse shell, and a WPScan brute-force attack; rated each by severity and wrote remediation steps.
- **Wazuh SIEM & XDR Platform Exploration | Wazuh**
 - Investigated Windows and Linux agents in Wazuh: CIS benchmark results, CVE findings and vulnerable software.
 - Hunted Windows Defender events in Discover and identified a Cobalt Strike signature; reviewed Sysmon ingestion, custom decoders and rules, FIM and Active Response.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **SIEM & Platforms:**
Splunk, Elastic Security, Wazuh, Microsoft Sentinel.
- **Detection Engineering:**
KQL, EQL, SPL; atomic, threshold, correlation and anomaly detection; alert tuning; false-positive analysis.
- **Monitoring & Response:**
Alert triage, incident investigation, log analysis, incident escalation, threat hunting, IOC and CVE analysis, vulnerability assessment.
- **Endpoint & Network:**
Sysmon, Windows Event Logs, Linux auth logs, Wireshark, Snort, Nmap.
- **Frameworks & Standards:**
MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, NIST CSF, ISO/IEC 27001 (fundamentals).
- **Foundations:**
Windows, Linux, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, HTTP/HTTPS.
- **Documentation:**
Incident reports, investigation notes, escalation handovers.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Fortinet NSE 1 – Cybersecurity and Cloud Fundamentals 1.0 | September 2026
- Fortinet NSE 2 – Introduction to Next Generation Firewall 1.0 | October 2026
- Intro to Splunk – Splunk Education | January 2026
- TryHackMe SOC Level 1 | In Progress
- AWS Security Learning Plan – Threat Detection and Incident Response | In Progress

VIRTUAL EXPERIENCE PROGRAMS (FORAGE)

- TCS Cybersecurity – IAM Developer Virtual Job Simulation | December 2025
- Shields Up: Cybersecurity Virtual Experience Program - AIG | December 2025
- Datacom Cyber Security Operations Virtual Experience Program | December 2025

EDUCATION

- M.Sc Cyber Forensics and Cyber Security | Amity University | Noida, Uttar Pradesh, India - (Aug 2024 – May 2026)
- B.Sc Forensic Science | Madurai Kamaraj University | Madurai, Tamilnadu, India - (July 2021 – April 2024)